



WHATSAPP CLOUD API · SETUP GUIDE · MAY 2026

META SYSTEM USER PERMANENT TOKEN

A 10-minute, one-time playbook that gets the Hi-Service Gas WhatsApp ordering bot a production-grade access token. Verified against current 2026 Meta Business Suite UI and three independent community references. Follow the seven steps and the token never expires again.

10 MIN

SETUP TIME

Click-by-click, start to finish

FOREVER

TOKEN EXPIRY

No 24-hour resets, no monthly renewals

R 0

MONTHLY COST

Meta-issued, no third-party fees

1 x

DONE FOREVER

Never touch this UI again post-setup

PREPARED FOR

Hi-Service Gas

WhatsApp ordering rebuild

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Technical guide

Operational reference

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THE TEMP TOKEN **DIES IN 24 HOURS**

Meta's developer dashboard issues a temporary token labelled "24 hours" on the WhatsApp API Setup page. In practice that token starts returning HTTP 401 the moment its 24-hour window closes — and every outbound message stops dead until it's replaced. Production WhatsApp ordering cannot run on temp tokens. The fix is one System User token, generated once, that never expires.

"Error validating access token: Session has expired on Friday, 22-May-26 00:00:00 PDT. The current time is Friday, 22-May-26 00:14:01 PDT."

META GRAPH API · ERROR CODE 190 · SUBCODE 463 · RETURNED TO HI-SERVICE CHATBOT DURING OUTBOUND ECHO TEST

BEFORE YOU START, CONFIRM THESE THREE THINGS EXIST

1 · BUSINESS MANAGER WITH HI-SERVICE INSIDE IT

The business.facebook.com dropdown shows a business that owns the WhatsApp app. Already set up in this case — Hi-Service Orders app was created here.

2 · "HI-SERVICE ORDERS" APP WITH WHATSAPP PRODUCT ADDED

The app exists at developer.facebook.com under the Hi-Service business. Use case "Connect with customers through WhatsApp" already selected. Already set up.

3 · A WABA VISIBLE IN THE WHATSAPP APP'S API SETUP PAGE

"Test WhatsApp Business Account" (id 1357146642926345) provisioned by Meta. The sandbox phone +1 555-629-8543 is its From-number. Already verified working.

STATE: READY TO GENERATE THE PERMANENT TOKEN

**A TOKEN GENERATED WITHOUT THE WABA ASSET ASSIGNED RETURNS 401
EVEN WHEN THE TOKEN LOOKS VALID.**

SYSTEM USER **AND ITS ASSETS**

The first three steps build the system user and grant it the two assets it needs. Asset assignment is the step almost everyone misses — without it, the Generate Token button stays greyed out, and even if you manage to generate a token it returns 401 on every Graph API call.

1 OPEN business.facebook.com /settings	2 NAVIGATE Users → System Users	3 ADD USER Name: hi-service- server · Role: Admin	4 ASSIGN WABA Full Control on the Hi-Service WABA	5 ASSIGN APP Full Control on Hi- Service Orders
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ASSET ASSIGNMENT — THE STEP EVERYONE MISSES

3A · WHATSAPP ACCOUNT ASSET

- Click **Add assets** on the system user detail page
- Left column: **WhatsApp Accounts**
- Tick the WABA + toggle **Full control** ON
- Save changes

3B · APP ASSET

- Click **Add assets** again
- Left column: **Apps**
- Tick **Hi-Service Orders** + Full control ON
- Save changes

WHY BOTH?

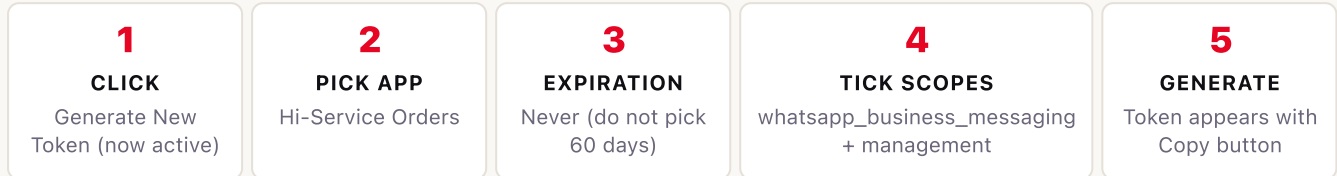
- **WABA** grants the token permission to act on WhatsApp
- **App** grants the token an identity (the App ID it acts as)
- One without the other → 401 errors

VERIFY BEFORE CONTINUING

- Generate New Token button **active** (blue, not grey)
- If still grey: an asset didn't save — re-do 3A or 3B
- Only move to page 4 once it's active

THE TOKEN **LIVE FOR YEARS**

With both assets assigned, the Generate Token dialog now offers the scopes we need. Pick the right four settings, copy the token once, paste into the Hi-Service admin panel.



COPY → VERIFY → PASTE — GET THIS EXACT SEQUENCE RIGHT

STEP 5 · COPY WITH META'S BUTTON, NOT THE KEYBOARD

Click Meta's **Copy** button inside the dialog. Do NOT triple-click + Cmd-C — keyboard selection sometimes captures an invisible line break that Meta's API will silently reject. Token starts with `EAA...` and is ~200–300 characters.

STEP 6A · VERIFY THE PASTE BEFORE SAVING

Open TextEdit / Sticky / a Gmail draft → paste → confirm: one unbroken string, starts with `EAA`, no spaces, no line breaks. If anything looks off, generate a new token (no penalty).

CRITICAL: CLOSING META'S DIALOG WITHOUT COPYING LOSES THE TOKEN FOREVER

STEP 6B · PASTE INTO HI-SERVICE ADMIN

Open `hiservice.store/admin/connections.php` → Meta WhatsApp card → click **Update Meta credentials** → System User Token field → **Cmd+A** → **Delete** → **Paste** the new token → **Save Meta**. The field is pre-filled with the OLD dead token's masked dots — overwriting is essential.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Once saved, ping the build session with "saved" — a 4-endpoint Graph API probe runs immediately to verify the token works before any real message is sent. If a snag does come up earlier, the table below maps the symptom to the exact step that fixes it.

SNAG	SEVERITY	WHAT IT MEANS	FIX
Generate Token button stays greyed out	HIGH	Asset assignment didn't complete — token cannot be generated against zero assets.	Re-do Step 3A and 3B. The button activates only after both assets save.
Only <code>whatsapp_business_management</code> visible, no <code>_messaging</code>	HIGH	WABA was assigned but without full control — Meta only grants management-level scopes.	Step 3A again. Toggle Full control ON (or both "Manage WhatsApp Business" and "Manage phone numbers and messages").
App dropdown empty in the Generate dialog	HIGH	The app asset was never assigned to the system user.	Step 3B. Add Hi-Service Orders as an Apps asset with Full control.
Token saved but still 401 on test	MED	Either a line break got into the paste, or the field still holds the old dead token's value.	Step 6b again. Cmd+A to clear first, then paste. Verify prefix differs from <code>EAAbZBpyiPS3UBRpy...</code>
"You don't have permission" page	MED	You're not Admin on the Business Portfolio that owns the app.	Business Settings → Business Info → check who has Admin. Ask owner to elevate, or use their account.

STANDING BY FOR "SAVED"

Once Step 6b is done, ping the active build session with the word "saved" and the 4-endpoint probe runs immediately. If all 4 return HTTP 200, you reply "hi" to +1 555-629-8543 and the echo arrives within five seconds — closing the inbound to outbound WhatsApp loop.

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